

Learning through play

“It’s exciting to see him do sort of skills like running and jumping that he couldn’t do, like, say a couple of months ago.”

“She counts up to five and she knows her family members’ names as well.”

At first, your child will develop their gross motor skills - like attempting to throw and catch a ball, running and jumping. As they get a bit older, they’ll enjoy using their hands to play games such as ‘Incy Wincy Spider’ and enjoy activities like scribbling, playing with dough and beginning to use their spoon and fork. They are now mastering how to balance themselves and have the ability to bend over without falling over, to reach for things on the floor and to pick up things from a standing position. Toddlers will learn to do things differently such as stand on one foot with assistance, or stand on their tippy toes.

Every child is different and does things in their own time

At three years old, their fine motor skills are beginning to show. They’ll begin to show spatial awareness by moving around objects instead of falling over them. They may have an understanding of the difference between morning and night. They will also be able to feed themselves and dress themselves - putting on a t-shirt or putting trousers on over their feet, putting on their socks and also putting on shoes that don’t need lacing up.

Top Tips

Your child can learn from items you have in the home

Toddlers love to open and close things like clips, zips and fasteners and are really fascinated about how things work. Try to provide toys that encourage these skills but be aware that they will be interested in your jars, your cupboards and your bottles as well.

When possible use cupboard and drawer locks to keep your child safe

Every day your toddler is learning to play, and they're learning important physical skills as they gain muscle control and coordination. Each skill enables them to learn more complicated ones, such as turning a cartwheel or jumping over a rope and kicking a ball on their own. Developing these physical skills will improve their strength, balance and coordination, which in turn will help their general brain development as they prepare for school. Watching your child develop is really exciting and there are lots of opportunities for you to have fun and explore with your child.

Give your child time to practice new skills

Trying new things helps brain development and prepares them for school.

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